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MAN O' WAR™

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS 2

By Andy Jones

Since the last set of Questions and Answers for Man O' War in White Dwarf 163 many more ships, Flyers and Sea Monsters have been released. Judging from the deluge of letters we have received, the resulting battles have intensified to fever pitch. A lot of the inevitable rules questions we've received have arisen from using these models and the new rules in Plague Fleet and Sea of Blood.

A few of the 'questions' have been attempts to get around a particular rule in a rather sneaky fashion – you know who you are! – but the vast majority are problems of interpretation of the rules, with the odd one or two pointing out contradictions. A lot of the problems arise from plain misreading of the rules, and rather than reprint the rulebook here we have left those questions to one side. Where an interesting point has been raised, however, we have provided the answer here. So all hands on deck and here we go...

GENERAL

Q "Does the result of 'The Captain is washed overboard by a freak wave...' on the Captain's Chart mean that the ship's next move must be 2" in the indicated direction, or does it move 2" immediately?"

A "The ship must move 2" in the indicated direction immediately, even if it has already moved this turn. This represents the ship's crew making a panicked attempt to rescue their rapidly drowning captain.

Q "If a Warbanner is lost on a roll of 1, does this mean that it is discarded and cannot be used for the rest of the engagement?"

A Yes, on a roll of 1 the Warbanner has been captured by the enemy crew and cannot be used for the rest of the game, let alone the rest of the engagement.

Q "It says on page 24 of the Man O' War rulebook that a vessel's Battle Honours depend on the number of below the waterline hits it has, yet things like Sea Monsters don't have below the waterline hits. How do you work out Battle Honours for them?"

A Sea Monsters don't have below the waterline hits, that's true, but they do have their Battle Honour value printed on their templates, as do all other vessels and creatures.

The rule about the Battle Honours being the same as a ship's below the waterline hits is a simplified version of the real situation, and only applies to the basic ships you get with the game.

Q "Can you deliberately target an empty area of sea with an area effect weapon, such as a Chaos Dwarf Great Leveller, in the hope that it will deviate from that point onto a vessel that couldn't otherwise be targeted?"

A No, not unless the rules for the weapon state that you can.

Q "Do you get +1 in a boarding action for having an Elf Wardancer counter in your crew stack?"

"When in a boarding action are Elf Wardancers killed?"

A As stated in the rulebook, Wardancers don't add to your boarding dice roll, but instead allow you to re-roll it if you think you can roll higher.

The Wardancer counter indicates that some or all of the crew are Wardancers, not that there are Wardancers aboard in addition to the normal crew. The counter isn't removed until all the crew is dead.

Q "Can a Kraken attack the crew aboard Dark Elf Sea Monsters, even though they don't have crew counters?"

A No, a Kraken can only use its crew attack if there are crew counters aboard the target. If the target hasn't any crew counters, the Kraken must attack the vessel itself.

Q "Can the Wizard start the game on any ship?"

A No, he must start on the command ship of the whole fleet (with the Admiral).

DWARFS

Q "Can a Dwarf Fleet dispel a Triton's spell on a roll of 6?"

A No, a Triton's spell is a special case; as stated in the last paragraph of page 12 of the Sea of Blood rulebook, the Triton's spell cannot be dispelled, even by a Dwarf's innate magical resistance.

CREW

Q "Given that an unmodified roll of 1 is always a failure (The Rule of 1, page 13 of the Man O' War rulebook), is a boarding action automatically lost on such a roll?"

A No, the Rule of One doesn't apply in this case as you are rolling *against* a similar dice roll that your opponent is making, rather than rolling *to do something*. Of course, rolling an unmodified 1 doesn't do your chances of winning the boarding action any good!

ELVES

Q "On page 51 of the Man O' War rulebook is states that 'Using (a Dragonship's) Dragonblade does not count as an attack. It is part of the Dragonship's movement.', yet on page 52 is states that the ship 'Must move at least 3" towards foe in a straight line with no turns...' just as if it were ramming. Which is correct?"

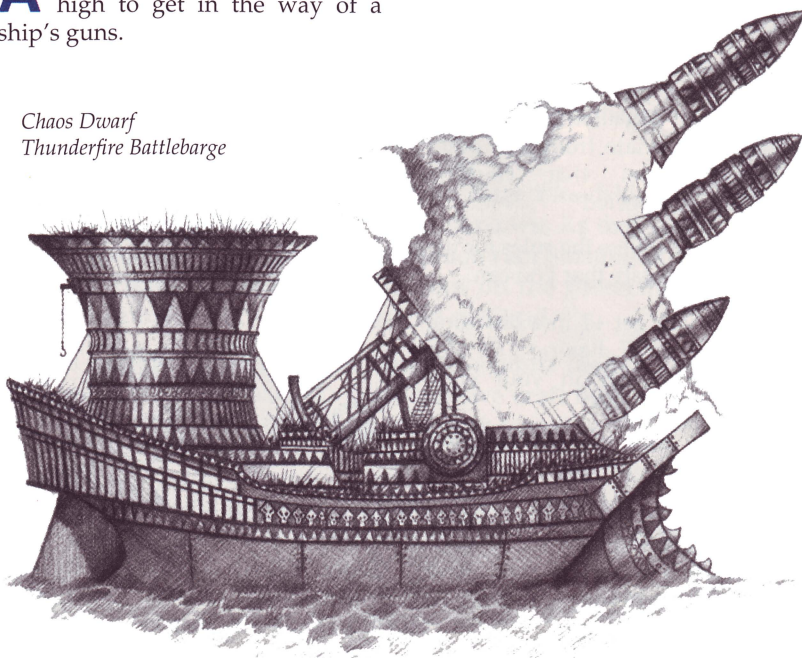
A Page 51. The Dragonship may use its Dragonblade as part of its normal move. It doesn't count as an attack.

FLYERS

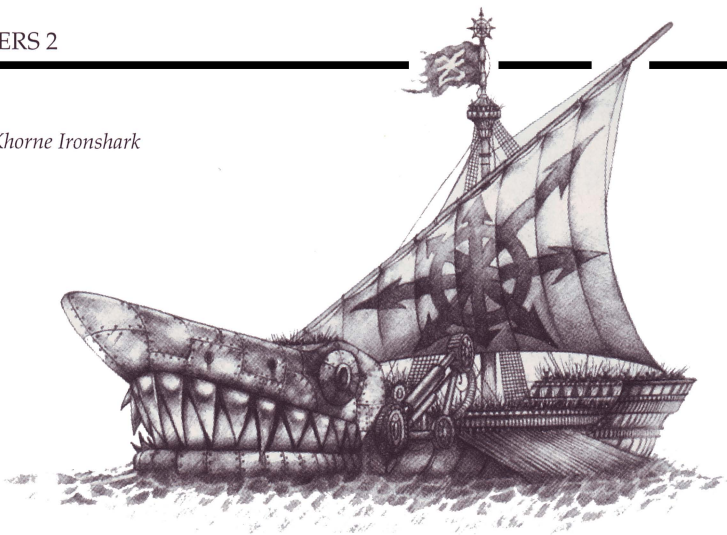
Q "Do Flyers block line of sight to ships behind them?"

A No, Flyers are generally too high to get in the way of a ship's guns.

*Chaos Dwarf
Thunderfire Battlebarge*



Khorne Ironshark



Q "Is it possible for a Flyer to rescue a Wizard, Admiral or other character from debris?"

A This is the sort of creative question that cannot be covered in the rules, if only because things like this don't always occur during playtesting. In this case, where the rules don't specifically prevent it, if all the players agree I don't see why not.

One of the most important parts of any game is dealing with odd situations like this. The general rule is that if all the players think it's fair and reasonable, then it probably is.

CHAOS

Q "Does Chaos Terrain block line of sight?"

A Yes, it does.

Q "A burning vessel enters the Sea of Change and rolls a 6, meaning that all of its damage counters are removed. Are all of its blaze markers also removed?"

A Yes, all damage on the ship is repaired by the Sea of Change!

Q "Is it possible for a Bane Tower of Tzeentch to get a Pink Horror counter for wounding a Sea Monster?"

A No, a Bane Tower, or Winged Terror for that matter, can only get a Pink Horror counter for destroying an enemy crew counter. It is the crew represented by this counter that are transformed into Pink Horrors.

Q "Does a Bolt of Tzeentch from a Bane Tower cause criticals?"

A No, as stated, unlike a Great Winged Terror, a Bane Tower's Bolts of Tzeentch do not cause criticals, as they are not as powerful.

Q "If a Bane Tower or Winged Terror of Tzeentch is set ablaze, do you remove an Energy of Tzeentch counter each time the blaze spreads?"

A Yes, when a location takes a hit from a blaze you should remove an Energy Counter, just as if it had been hit by enemy cannons.

Q "Do you have to discard Energy of Tzeentch counters to make a roll to repair a Bane Tower of Tzeentch?"

A No, you simply assign 1 or more energy dice to repairs rather than movement or firing. For each one that comes up a 5 or 6 the Bane Tower regains one Energy of Tzeentch counter.

Q "In a boarding action, how many Nurgle's Rot Counters are placed on a ship per turn?"

A Each time a ship's crew attacks, or is attacked by a Plagueship a Nurgle's Rot counter is placed on their ship. This means that if a combat see-saws between the two sides, more than one Nurgle's Rot counter can be placed on the ship in a single turn.

Q "Can a Deathburner have a Ship Rot Chaos Reward even though it doesn't have a catapult?"

A Yes, Chaos Rewards like this include the extra weapon. The ship now has a putrescent, organic catapult mounted on its deck.



Q "It states in the Plague Fleet rulebook that a Plaguecrusher may only be given Chaos Rewards of Nurgle, yet it is a Ship of The Line and therefore cannot buy Chaos Rewards. How does it get them?"

A When drawing Chaos Experience counters in a campaign it is possible to draw a Chaos Reward rather than a crew counter, thus allowing even Ships of The Line to get Chaos Rewards.

Q "Does a Plagueship's slime trail affect a Nurgle Fleet's allies?"

A Yes, it does. However, it doesn't affect other Nurgle ships, such as Deathgalleys with Nurgle rewards, as they already have various foul diseases on board and are less likely to suffer the extreme effects of Nurgle's Rot.

Q "On the bow location of the Hellrammer's template there is a cannon marked, while on the Slaanesh Fleet List it says the Hellrammer has no ranged weapons. Which is correct?"

A The template: the Hellrammer has a single, bow-mounted forward-firing cannon.

Q "Do ships under the influence of the Whispering Death Chaos Reward just fire all their guns?"

A No, they make all the attacks they can, including boarding actions against friendly ships if they are in a position to do so.

DARK ELVES

Q "If you wish to counterboard a Black Ark of Naggaroth (after winning a boarding action in defence) do you still have to roll for the Maze of Traps?"

A Yes, every crew counter that attempts to board a Black Ark of Naggaroth must roll to see if it can get past the Maze of Traps.

SPELLS

Q "Is it possible to move into a Vortex of Chaos deliberately without taking damage?"

A No, definitely not! The Vortex damages anything it touches whether it moves onto it, or is itself moved onto. An Admiral must be suicidal to consider doing such a thing.



Q "Can you extinguish and repair a blazing location using a Repair or Aura of Growth spell?"

A No, any fires on the chosen locations must be extinguished before these spells can work.

Q "When the Howling Insanity spell is used against a ship with turrets, which directions do they fire in?"

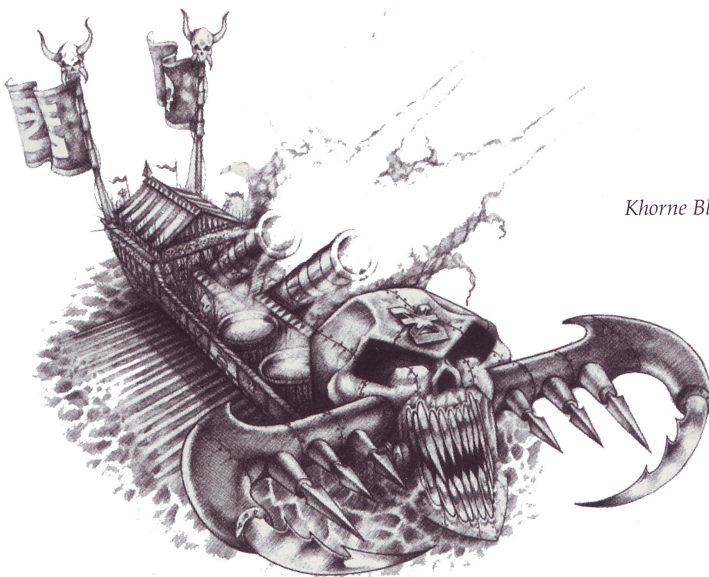
A A Turret will fire in its rest position: the direction it is facing when not being used. To determine the direction of rest for each turret look at the model and the ship's template; a forward-mounted turret fires forward, a side-mounted turret fires a broadside, and so on, using common sense to resolve any arguments.

Q "What happens to Chaos and Skaven Sorcerers' spells when they are washed overboard?"

A If a Chaos Sorcerer finds himself in the water he is treated just like normal Wizard and loses all his spell cards until he gets back on deck.

Note, however, that a Chaos Sorcerer can only end up in the water if he is first moved via a magic spell to another ship, as rather than sinking his Bane Tower usually blows up taking him with it.

A Skaven Sorcerer doesn't lose any cards or tokens if the ship he is on sinks, although he is unable to cast spells while in the water.



Khorne Bloodship

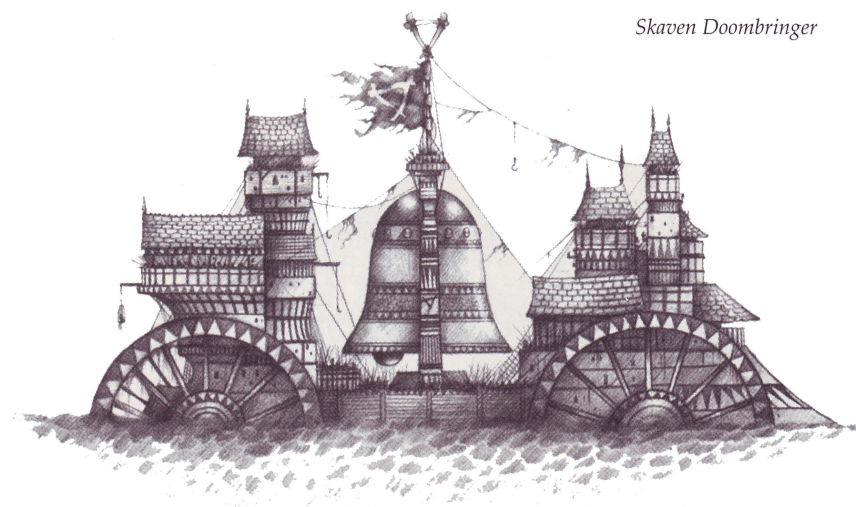
SKAVEN

Q “Does the Skaven Doombringer’s Great Bell affect Flyers?”

A No, as the Great Bell is the Skaven Doombringer’s main armament it cannot affect Flyers (see the top of column two on page 17 of the Sea of Blood Rulebook: ‘Defensive Fire... is the only way a ship without special weapons may fire at a Flyer’). This is the reason that the Skaven fleet must buy Firethrowers to destroy Flyers!

In fact, for the record, any ship’s main armament – be it cannons, catapults, Thunderfire Rockets, or whatever – may not fire at Flyers.

Skaven Doombringer



SKAVEN CREW

The rules for Skaven crew seem to be causing some confusion. We have even had questions asking “Why do the Skaven get as many free crew as they like – it’s not fair”. Clearly this is not the case.

The important thing to remember is that, with the exception of Rat-ogres and Assassins, Skaven crew counters do not have to be bought from the Clanfleet’s total point allocation. Instead, for each 1000 points worth of ships in the Clanfleet you get 20 Slave counters,

20 Clanrat counters and 5 Storm Vermin counters absolutely free to distribute amongst them.

To make this clearer the table below lists a sample 1000 point Skaven Clanfleet and the crew each ship contains.

1000 POINT SKAVEN FLEET		CREW (Different Types Cannot Be Mixed Within A Single Squadron)				
SHIP	POINTS VALUE	SLAVES	CLANRATS	STORM VERMIN	RAT OGRES	ASSASSINS
DOOMBRINGER (Clanfleet Flagship) 1 Doombringer 1 Skaven Warlord 1 Grey Seer 2 Rat Ogres 1 Assassin	200 Free 100 2 @ 50 50	–	–	5	(2)	(1)
WARP-RAIDER SQUADRON Warp-raider (Flagship) Warp-raider Warp-raider	75	4 2 2	– – –	– – –	– – –	– – –
WARP-RAIDER SQUADRON Warp-raider (Flagship) Warp-raider Warp-raider	75	2 2 2	– – –	– – –	– – –	– – –
WARP-RAIDER SQUADRON Warp-raider (Flagship) Warp-raider Warp-raider	75	2 2 2	– – –	– – –	– – –	– – –
DEATHBURNER SQUADRON Deathburner (Flagship) Deathburner Deathburner	150	– – –	3 3 3	– – –	– – –	– – –
DEATHBURNER SQUADRON Deathburner (Flagship; Chaos Reward) Deathburner Deathburner	150+25	– – –	5 3 3	– – –	– – –	– – –
TOTALS	1000	20	20	5	(2)	(1)
		This set of Skaven crew is free.			This set is bought.	